

Russell Dudek

APPLIED AI PRODUCT & OPERATING SYSTEMS

The gap is real. The transfer is testable.

A candid response to the strongest plausible hiring concern.

The Objection

"Russell has not held the formal title of AI Product Director, and his experience is adjacent to partnership marketing rather than inside the agency category."

What Not to Do

Do not claim equivalence

Operations leadership, AI advisory, and technical program work are not the same as years of affiliate product management.

Do not lead with title hierarchy

The role needs hands-on product judgment, workflow discovery, prototyping, governance, evaluation, and adoption.

Do not hide behind AI language

Tool familiarity is secondary to whether the product changes decisions, work, economics, and client outcomes.

Do not prescribe before learning

AP's actual workflows, architecture, data, controls, incentives, and roadmap are not public.

The Transfer Case

Role need | Verified adjacent evidence | Interview proof

Turn AI demand into product decisions | DudeWorth value, feasibility, readiness, adoption, agentic workflow, evaluation, and governance frameworks. | Apply the Fold to a real workflow and make a fund/hold/stop call.

Embed product into operations | Vape-Jet AI-first transformation across production, quality, support, ERP, telemetry, and engineering. | Map owner, behavior, handoff, telemetry, and benefit realization.

Build cross-functional mechanisms | Amazon distributed operating routines and Compunetics engineering/quality/delivery systems. | Design decision rights, cadence, escalation, and learning loop.

Operate with trust and consequence | High-reliability electronics, regulated drone operations, quality systems, safety record. | Define human authority, evaluation, exceptions, rollback, and controls.

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How to Test the Candidacy

Recommended Interview Exercise

Choose one real recurring AP workflow that leadership believes could benefit from applied AI. Provide enough context to understand the users, current work, desired outcome, and constraints. Then evaluate Russell on the reasoning process, not on guessing hidden architecture.

1. Frame the outcome

What client or operating decision should improve? What is the current baseline and unit?

2. Surface hidden judgment

What context do experts use that is not obvious in the documented process?

3. Bound authority

What may AI retrieve, draft, recommend, execute, or escalate? What remains human?

4. Define trust

What data, permission, evaluation, audit, and failure conditions matter?

5. Find reuse

Which context, behavior, workflow, or control is stable across accounts or regions?

6. Prove or stop

What evidence earns the next investment? What result triggers hold or retirement?

Evidence That Would Increase Confidence

- Clear decomposition of a messy service workflow into a product contract.
- Respect for client context and human expertise rather than automation maximalism.
- Specific assumptions, risks, owners, and measurement units.
- A pragmatic first release and a credible adoption path.
- Willingness to stop a weak idea despite technical excitement.

Residual Risk

Domain ramp remains necessary. Mitigate it through structured immersion with account teams, analytics, publisher development, technology partners, and client leadership; pair early product bets with domain co-owners; and use the first 30 days to learn the category's language, economics, workflows, and trust boundaries.

Bottom Line

Do not hire Russell because adjacent experience sounds similar. Hire him only if the working session demonstrates that he can make the product decision clearer, preserve the expertise that matters, and build an operating mechanism that turns evidence into adoption and value.